

Jenny Jiwon Kim

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Research Interests

I am broadly interested in human-centered AI for mental health. My current research explores (1) aligning language models with expert therapeutic knowledge, (2) evaluating and improving the safety of AI in mental health conversations, and (3) understanding how people perceive and engage with AI in mental health contexts.

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign <i>Ph.D. in Computer Science, Advisor: Prof. Koustuv Saha</i>	<i>Aug 2025 – Present</i> <i>Champaign, IL, USA</i>
Seoul National University <i>B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering & Bachelor of Business Administration</i>	<i>Mar 2019 – Aug 2025</i> <i>Seoul, Korea</i>

Publications

LLUMI: Improving LLM Writing Assistance for Mental Health Support with Online Community Feedback 🔗
Jiwon Kim, Maya Ajit, Sherry Gong, Soorya Ram Shimgekar, Dong Whi Yoo, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Koustuv Saha
EMNLP Main Conference 2026

AI Psychosis: Does Conversational AI Amplify Delusion-Related Language? 🔗
Soorya Ram Shimgekar, Vipin Gunda, Jiwon Kim, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Hari Sundaram, Koustuv Saha
EMNLP Main Conference 2026

PeerPen: AI-Assisted Writing for Online Mental Health Peer Support 🔗
Jiwon Kim, Sherry Gong, Maya Ajit, Soorya Ram Shimgekar, Yunhao Yuan, Dong Whi Yoo, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Koustuv Saha
CHI 2027 (under submission)

PAIR-SAFE: A Paired-Agent Approach for Runtime Auditing and Refining AI-Mediated Mental Health Support 🔗
Jiwon Kim, Violeta J. Rodriguez, Dong Whi Yoo, Eshwar Chandrasekharan, Koustuv Saha
ACL ARR 2027 (under submission)

AI Content Moderation in Therapy Conversations 🔗
Jiwon Kim, Claire Wang, Taeung Yoon, Sabelle Huang, Koustuv Saha
ICWSM Digital Minds Workshop 2026

Experience

AI Researcher <i>Dalphi AI, Core AI Team</i>	<i>Dec 2024 – May 2025</i> <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
- Implemented an end-to-end AI search pipeline combining text and image-based retrieval methods. - Designed AI brand recognition tools for video understanding, enabling efficient logo detection and visual analytics.	
Human-Oriented Language Intelligence Lab <i>Undergraduate Researcher, Seoul National University</i>	<i>Mar 2024 – Dec 2024</i> <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
Developed value-aligned LLM chatbot for persuasion that generates tailored arguments by embedding user-specific patterns and topic preferences using contrastive learning.	
Real-Time Ubiquitous Systems Lab <i>Undergraduate Researcher, Seoul National University</i>	<i>Jul 2023 – Jan 2024</i> <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
Implemented a mobile sensing application detecting risk factors of adolescent mental health using real-time data.	
Data Analytics Manager <i>Cclim, Social Venture</i>	<i>Jan 2021 – Dec 2021</i> <i>Seoul, Korea</i>
Designed methods to measure local advertisement exposure by using AI video recognition APIs.	